made a basic mistake. On seeing this, Eskay tried to point it out but I hushed him. The poor chap, thinking he was wrong since I was the physics 'expert', went down the same path. We were promptly hauled up for cheating, with Eskay clearly aggrieved at my pig-headedness of not heeding his warning. We looked suitably repentant as we stood before the instructor, Major Singh. We kept our mouths shut as he ranted and raved but ultimately let us off, saying that since both of us had got a big fat zero in that question, neither of us had really gained any unfair advantage. The fact that neither of us would say 'who' had copied from 'whom' and were ready to face the music together, I think, appealed to his sense of honour. We were saved from relegation yet again, due to a practical interpretation of the situation by the instructor, something I tried to apply myself throughout my career.

Once during my third or fourth term, I was fast asleep on a Sunday morning, having had a sumptuous breakfast, when someone knocked on the door to say that some guests from Pune had come to meet me. I looked out of the window and saw that it was my uncle, Dr Arawind Parasnis, a professor at IIT Kanpur, along with my cousins Kaushik and Gautam, as well as Veena and Uma. Guests were a welcome change from the routine but not at the cost of the Sunday afternoon siesta. I hastily put on some clothes and went down to meet them. We drove around the Academy and went to the picturesque Peacock Bay. Although I was happy to see Veena and my cousins, I was rather grumpy throughout on account of being woken up from my hibernation, something that Veena reminds me of even today.

The sixth term was quite uneventful as I kept a low profile and out of trouble, intent only on graduating with my course. Two incidents, though, stand out. We had international

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